PS 5 · THE FAKE HR EMAIL

CUSTODI

Think before you trust.

Verify before you act.

An on-device check for placement, internship and recruiter messages.



ARTHAKRAM RAPID PROTOTYPING HACKATHON · ANTRIKSH · DARSH · KUSHAGRI

It doesn't look like a scam.

It looks like a first job offer.

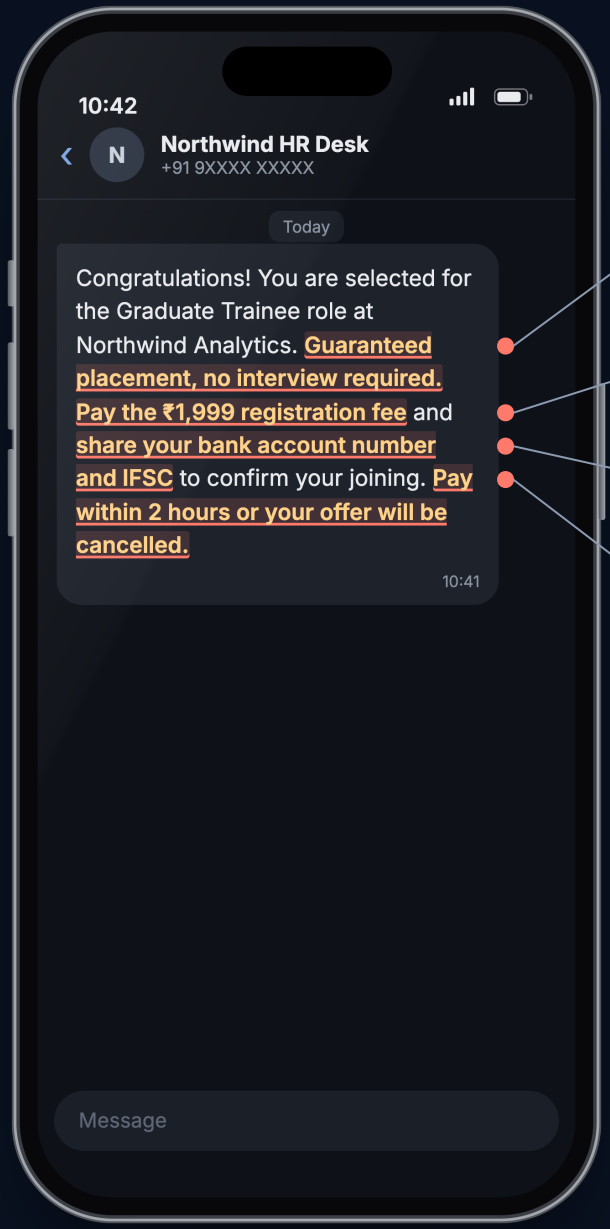
PS 5 — THE FAKE HR EMAIL

A student pastes a suspicious message and instantly receives a risk level, reasons, a clear next step, and a reminder to verify through the placement cell.

Named dangers OTP theft · ignored training · alert fatigue

WHY "BE CAREFUL" FAILS

Deadlines beat training. Constant warnings get ignored. And between receiving and verifying, the student has only the message.



Fictional message

Guaranteed selection, no interview

A reward with no process

Registration fee

Real employers don't charge to hire

Bank details by message

Before any offer is accepted

A two-hour deadline

No time to ask the placement cell

CUSTODI ON THIS EXACT MESSAGE

100 /100 · High

+30 fee · +20 fee in a job context · +20 no assessment · +20 bank details · +10 urgency

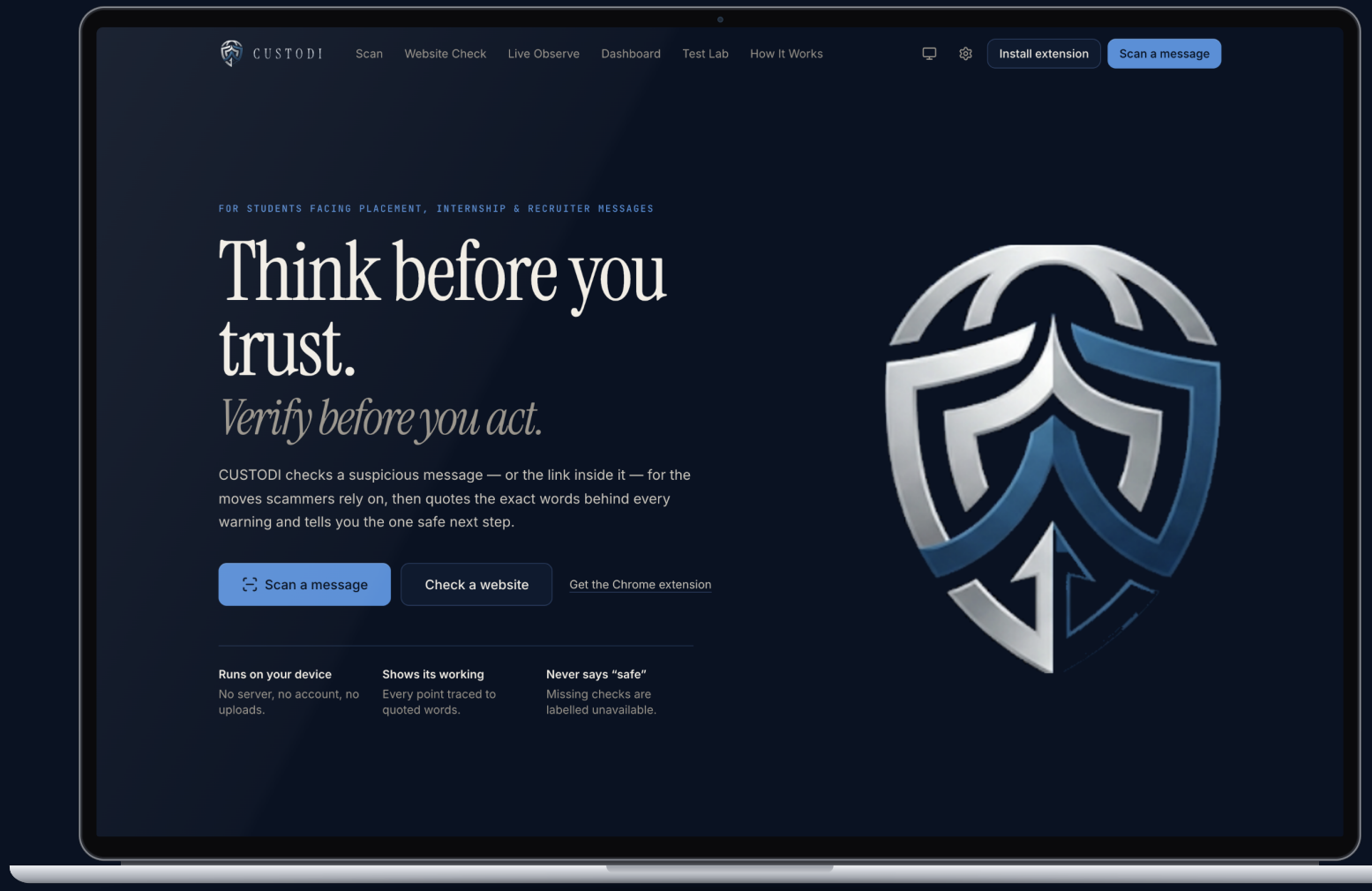
Check first. Then decide.

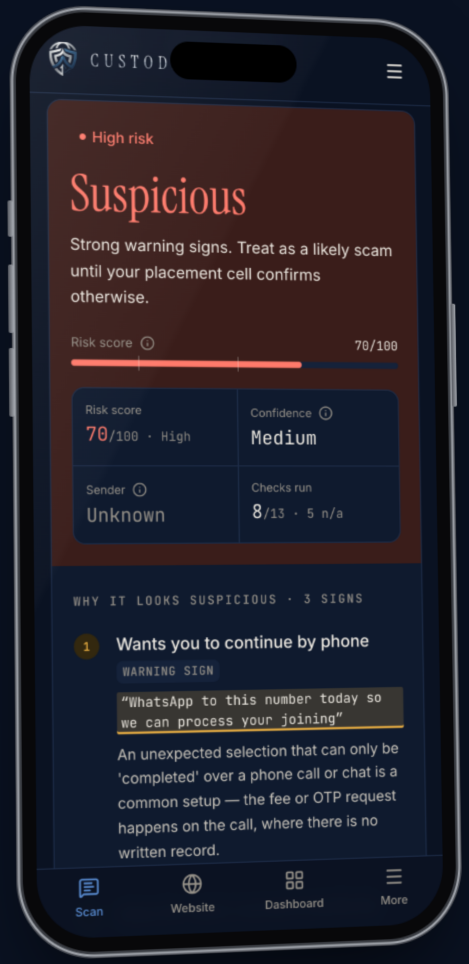
Real screens — website on desktop, message scan on mobile

01
Message scanner
Paste email, SMS or WhatsApp text

02
Website checker
Reads an address without opening it

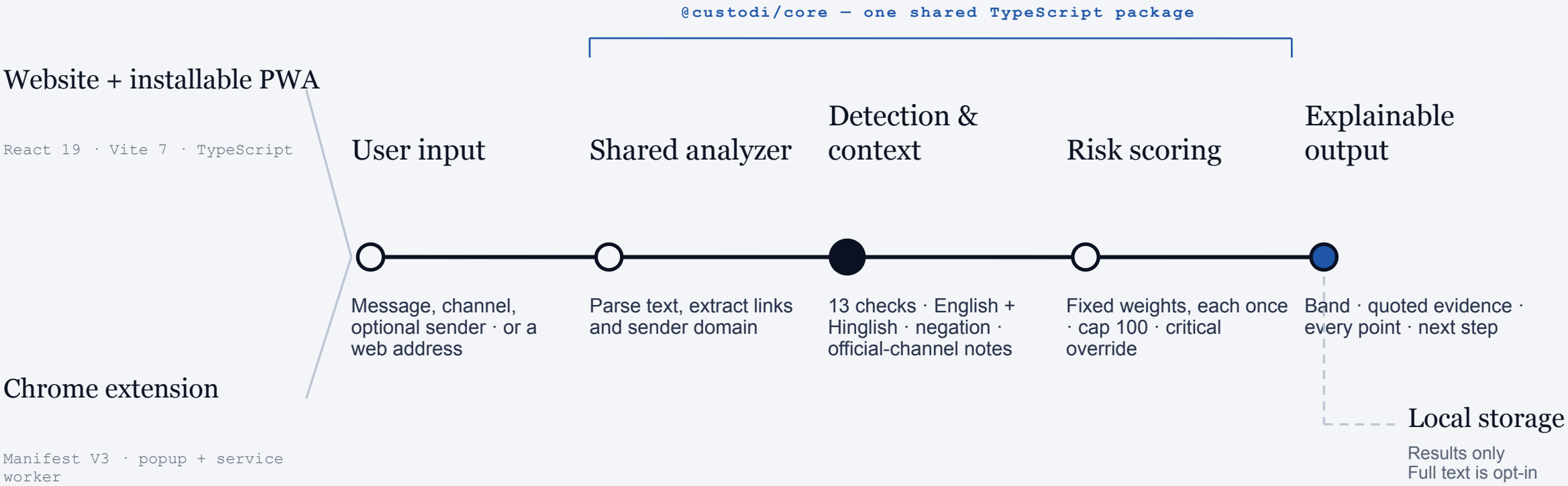
03
Chrome extension
Scans the page you're on — on click





One engine. Every surface.

Deterministic TypeScript, running on the device. No server, no AI API.



WHY IT'S PRACTICAL

Predictable and testable · no per-scan cost · nothing leaves the device · website, app and extension can't disagree

Same request. Three answers.

All three ask for bank account details. Context — not keywords — changes the verdict.

Also handled negation (“never share your OTP”), stipends ≠ fees, scam text quoted in warnings.

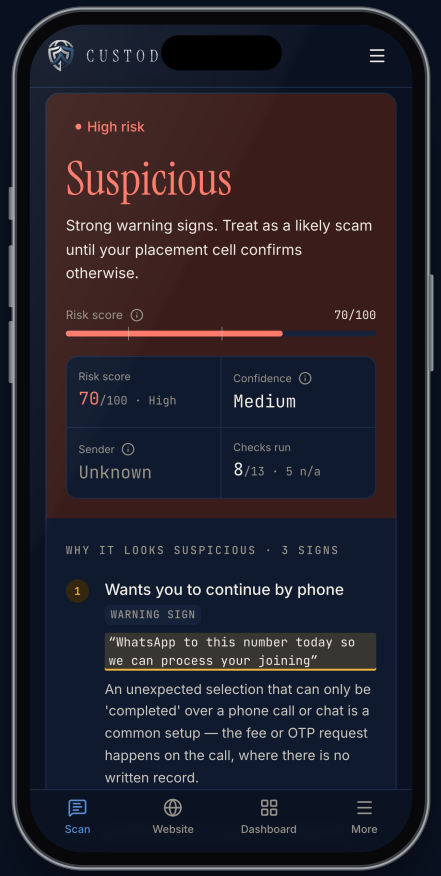
Limit CUSTODI reads the wording — it can't confirm a portal is genuinely official.

70 /100

High

WhatsApp, before any offer

DEMO MESSAGE

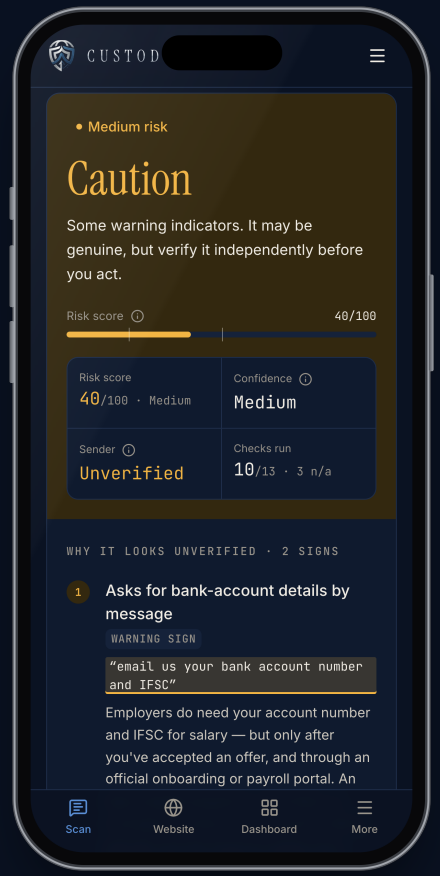


40 /100

Caution

Email after accepting — from a Gmail address

TEST LAB R10

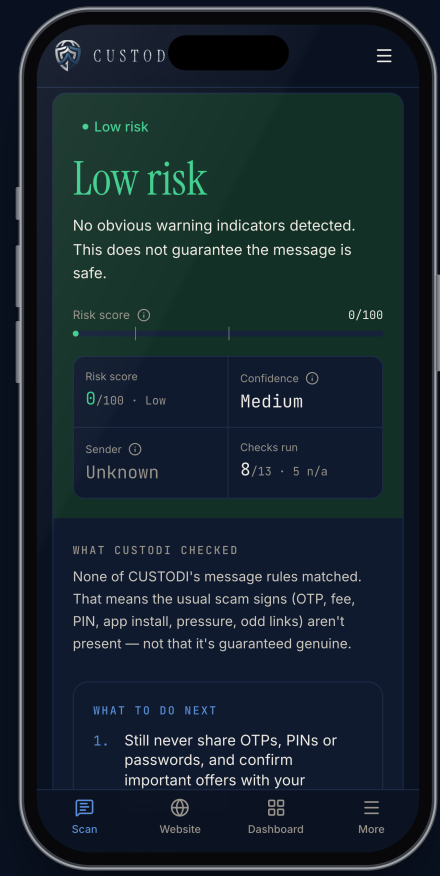


0 /100

Low

After accepting — via the official onboarding portal

TEST LAB M42

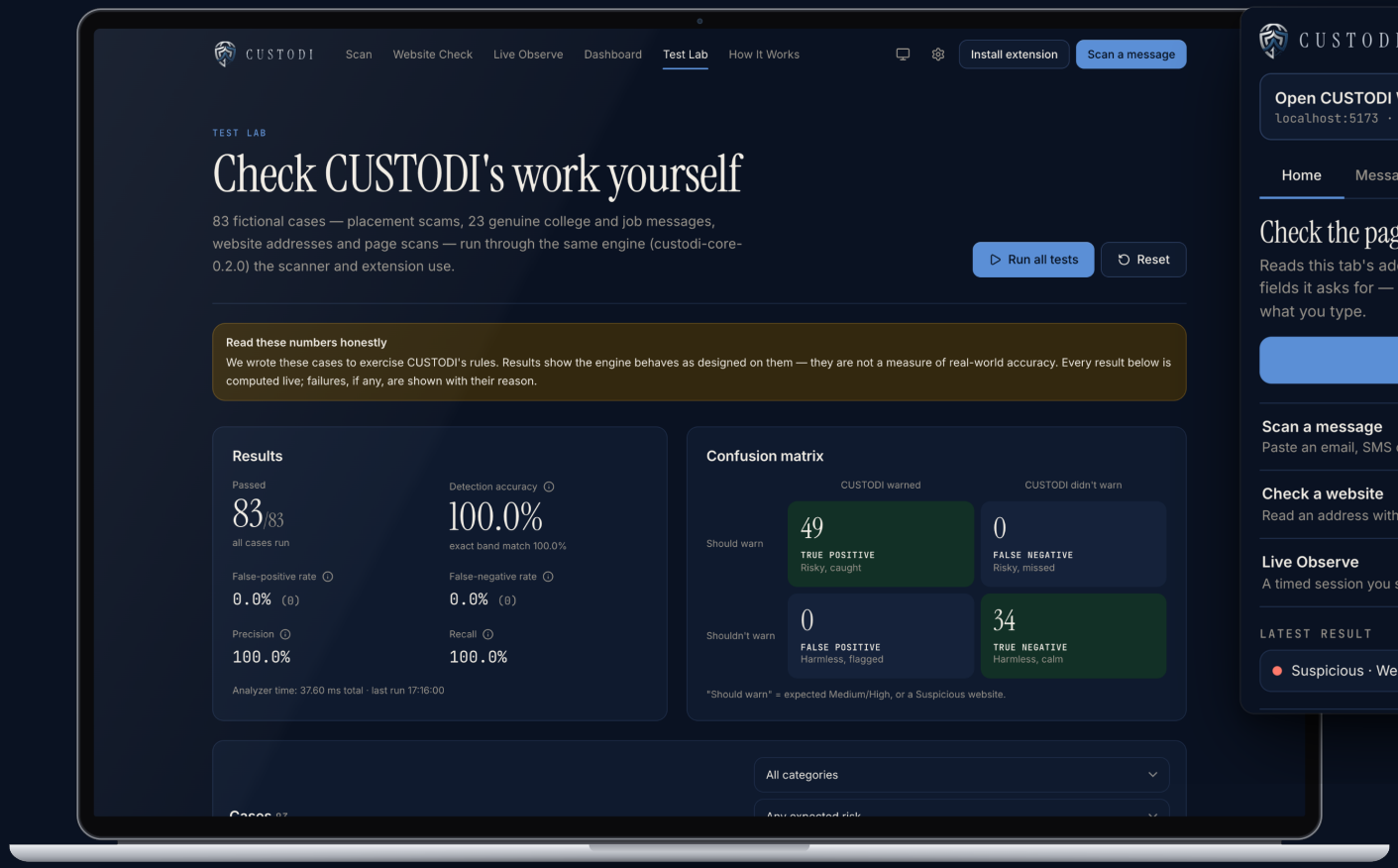


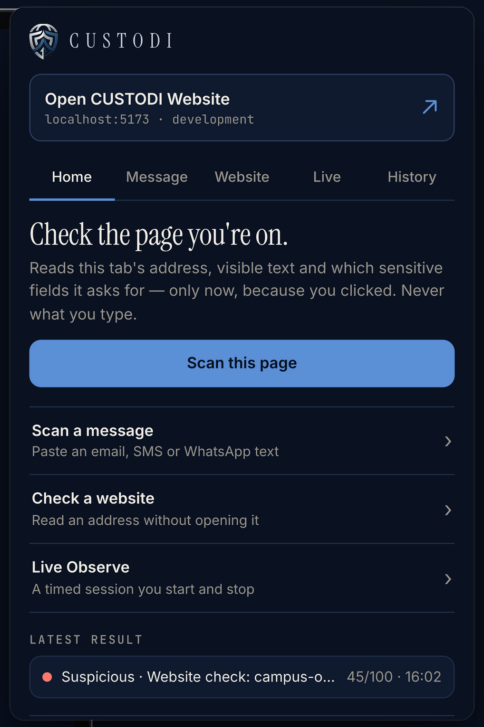
Runs on what students already have.

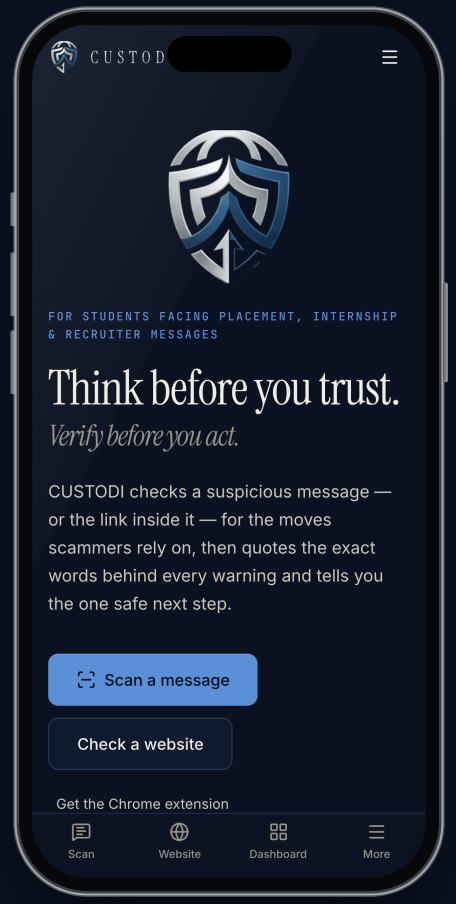
Local-first
No server, no cloud, no paid API

Private
Scans only when asked; never reads inboxes

Simple to run
Static hosting; plain-language results



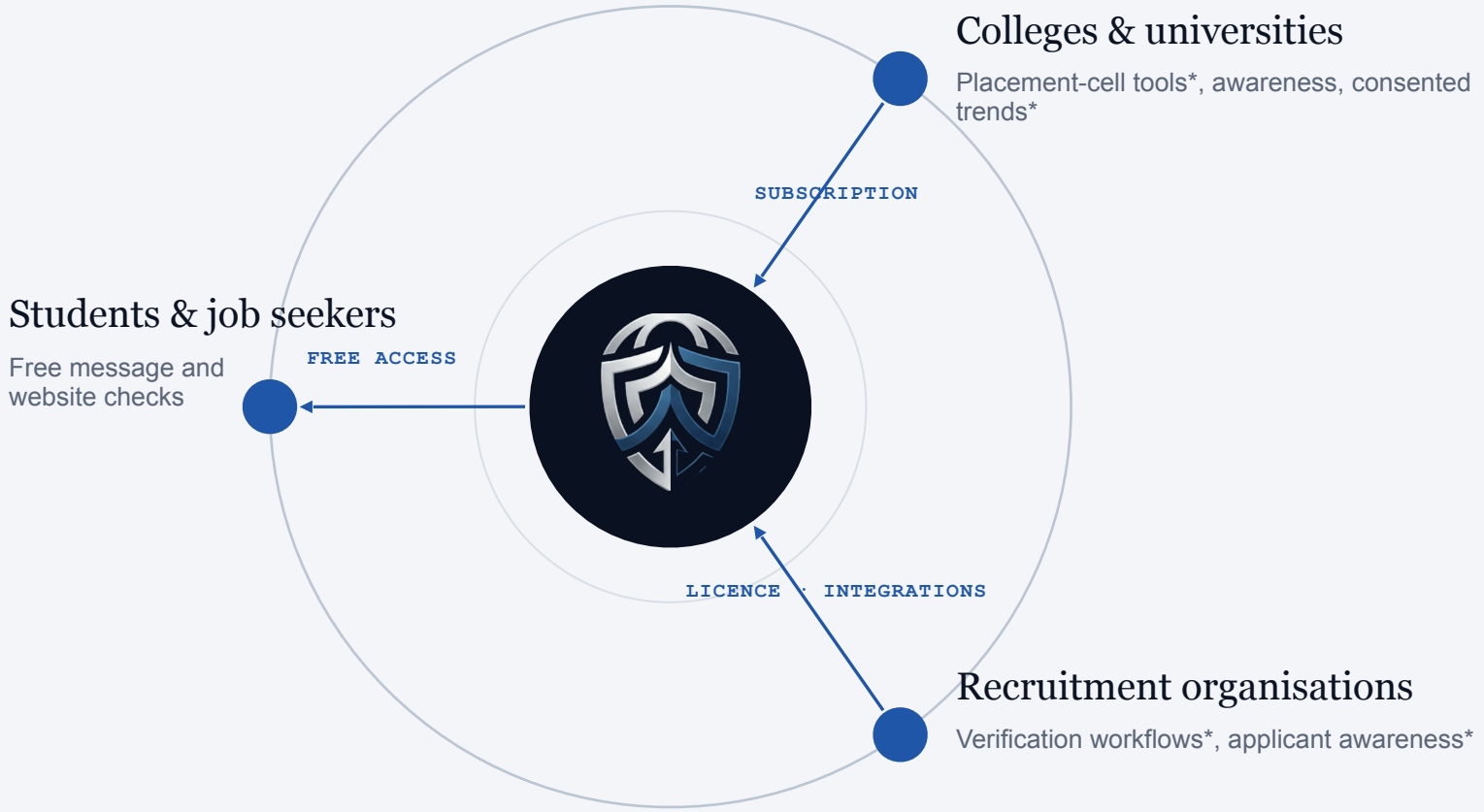




120/120 unit tests · **83/83** Test Lab cases · **110** production page loads, 0 errors · **extension driven in real Chrome**

Test Lab cases are our own fictional ones — not a real-world accuracy claim.

Free for students. Funded by institutions.



PROPOSED MODEL — NOT EXISTING REVENUE

01 **Free individual access**
Core checks stay free and private

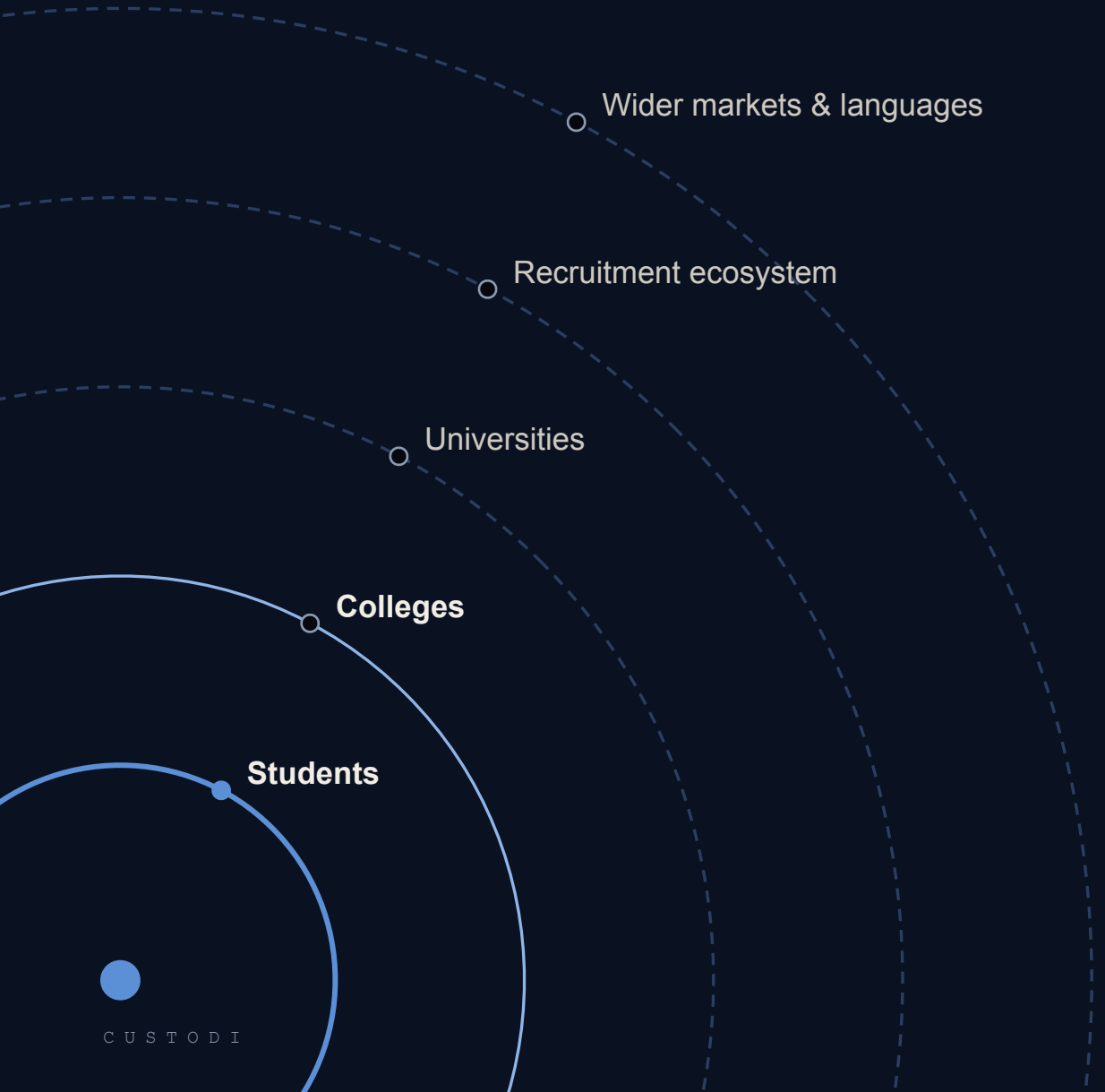
02 **Institutional subscriptions**
Colleges and universities

03 **Enterprise licensing**
Recruitment organisations

04 **Custom integrations**
Placement portals and deployments

Preventing even one student from losing money or identity documents can justify a college's subscription.

** Not built yet. No customers, pricing or willingness to pay validated.*



From one student to a whole recruitment ecosystem.

WORKING TODAY

13-check engine, website checker, extension, installable app
English + common Hinglish · fully local

PLANNED NEXT

Placement-cell pilot · Chrome Web Store
More rules and formats · opt-in institution backend

LONG-TERM

University and recruiter partnerships
More Indian languages, then other regions

Only the solid inner ring exists today. No partnerships or customers yet.

Others ask if it's known to be bad. CUSTODI asks if it makes sense.

	Spam filters	URL reputation checkers	Browser security	Manual verification	CUSTODI
Built for recruitment scams	Not the focus	Not the focus	Not the focus	Yes	**Yes**
Reads what the message asks you to do	Partly	Not the focus	Not the focus	Yes	**Yes**
Checks web addresses	Often	Yes	Yes	Manually	**Structure only**
Known-bad reputation data	Yes	Yes	Yes	Partly	**No**
Explains each point	Rarely	Partly	Rarely	Yes	**Yes**
Context-aware bank / payroll reading	Not the focus	Not the focus	Not the focus	Yes	**Yes**
Instant, at any hour	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	**Yes**
Local-first — nothing uploaded	Varies	No	Varies	n/a	**Yes**

Based on each category's typical purpose — individual products vary. CUSTODI complements these tools; it doesn't replace them.

Recruitment-specific context · explainable · message + website · local-first — in one place.



C U S T O D I

The cost of trusting the wrong message is far greater than the time it takes to verify it.

Think before you trust. Verify before you act.

github.com/govindanidarsh/Custodi